

64 David

Shepherd, giant-killer, king and psalm-writer, a man after God's own heart who fell hard and turned back to God.

David was the youngest son of Jesse of Bethlehem, a shepherd boy no one expected to be chosen. Samuel anointed him while Saul still reigned. David killed Goliath, then spent years on the run from Saul's jealousy. He became king over all Israel, made Jerusalem his capital, and received God's promise of a throne for ever. He also fell into adultery and murder, and his family suffered for it. Yet he confessed honestly and threw himself on God's mercy. The Messiah would be called "the son of David."

At a glance

<i>Name</i>	Hebrew <i>David</i> , usually explained as "beloved"
<i>Family</i>	Youngest son of Jesse, of Judah; great-grandson of Ruth (Ruth 4:17)
<i>Wives named</i>	Michal, Abigail, Bathsheba and others (2 Samuel 3:2-5)
<i>Reign</i>	c. 1010-970 BC: 7½ years in Hebron, 33 in Jerusalem (2 Samuel 5:4-5)
<i>Key places</i>	Bethlehem, Elah, Adullam, Ziklag, Hebron, Jerusalem
<i>Key people</i>	Saul, Jonathan, Nathan, Bathsheba, Absalom, Solomon
<i>Writings</i>	73 psalms carry his name in their Hebrew titles
<i>New Testament</i>	Often; Jesus is "son of David" (Matthew 1:1)

"For the LORD seeth not as man seeth; for man looketh on the outward appearance, but the LORD looketh on the heart."

1 Samuel 16:7, KJV

The life of David

Dates are approximate. He was 30 when he became king and reigned 40 years (2 Samuel 5:4).

Youth	● Anointed in Bethlehem Samuel passes over Jesse's older sons and anoints the youngest. The Spirit of the LORD comes on David. <i>1 Samuel 16:1-23</i>
Youth	● Faces Goliath David hears Goliath's challenge and kills him with a sling in the name of the LORD. <i>1 Samuel 17:1-58</i>
Saul's last years	● A hunted man Saul's jealousy drives David from court. He hides in the wilderness, spares Saul twice, and settles at Ziklag. <i>1 Samuel 18-30</i>
c. 1010 BC Age 30	● King in Hebron After Saul dies, the men of Judah anoint David king in Hebron. <i>2 Samuel 1:1-2:11; 5:4-5</i>
c. 1003 BC Age 37	● King in Jerusalem All the tribes anoint David. He takes Zion, makes Jerusalem his capital, and brings up the ark. <i>2 Samuel 5:1-10; 6:1-19</i>
Middle of his reign	● Sin and repentance David takes Bathsheba and arranges Uriah's death. Nathan confronts him, and David confesses. <i>2 Samuel 11:1-12:25</i>
Later years	● Absalom's revolt Absalom seizes the throne and David flees. Absalom is killed, and David mourns him bitterly. <i>2 Samuel 13:1-19:8</i>
c. 970 BC Age 70	● Solomon crowned When Adonijah grasps at the throne, David has Solomon anointed, charges him, and dies. <i>1 Kings 1:1-2:11</i>

Key activities

73 psalm titles include "of David"; some read authorship in every case, others "for" or "in the style of" David. The New Testament names him as speaker of several (Mark 12:36; Acts 2:25).

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- I Guarded the flock.** He fought off a lion and a bear, and trusted God against Goliath too. *1 Samuel 17:34-37*

 - 2 Defeated Goliath.** He came "in the name of the LORD of hosts." *1 Samuel 17:45-47*

 - 3 Made a covenant with Jonathan.** Saul's son became his closest friend and protector. *1 Samuel 18:1-4; 20:1-42*

 - 4 Spared the LORD's anointed.** Twice he had Saul at his mercy and refused to harm him. *1 Samuel 24:1-22; 26:1-25*

 - 5 Strengthened himself in God.** At burned Ziklag, "David encouraged himself in the LORD his God." *1 Samuel 30:1-20*

 - 6 Took Jerusalem and brought the ark.** He made Zion his capital and "danced before the LORD with all his might" as the ark came in. *2 Samuel 5:6-10; 6:12-15*

 - 7 Received God's covenant.** God promised to build David's house, a kingdom for ever. *2 Samuel 7:1-29*

 - 8 Showed kindness to Saul's family.** He brought Jonathan's lame son Mephibosheth to eat at the king's table. *2 Samuel 9:1-13*

 - 9 Fell and repented.** Confronted, he said, "I have sinned against the LORD." *2 Samuel 11-12; Psalm 51:10*

 - 10 Grieved for a rebel son.** He wept, "O my son Absalom, my son, my son Absalom!" *2 Samuel 18:33*

 - 11 Bought a place for the altar.** He refused to offer what "doth cost me nothing"; it became the temple site. *2 Samuel 24:1-25; 2 Chronicles 3:1*

 - 12 Prepared for the temple.** Not allowed to build it himself, he gathered materials and gave Solomon the plans. *1 Chronicles 22:1-19; 28:1-29:9*

Across Scripture

Direct references come first. Thematic echoes are study connections, not places where the text names David.

Old Testament

1 Samuel 16 – 1 Kings 2; 1 Chronicles 11–29	The two main accounts
2 Samuel 23:1	"The sweet psalmist of Israel"; see Psalms 3 and 51
1 Kings 15:5	Right "save only in the matter of Uriah the Hittite"
Isaiah 11:1; Jeremiah 23:5	A king from "the stem of Jesse"

New Testament

Matthew 1:1	Jesus Christ, "the son of David"
Luke 1:32; 2:4, 11	"The throne of his father David"; born in David's city
Matthew 22:41–45	How can David's son be David's Lord?
Acts 13:22	"A man after mine own heart"
Revelation 22:16	"I am the root and the offspring of David"

For discussion

1. *Observe:* What did God look at when he chose David, and what did everyone else look at (1 Samuel 16:6–13)?
2. *Understand:* David sinned terribly, yet was a man after God's own heart. What does that say about what God values?
3. *Apply:* David wrote honest prayers in both joy and failure. What would an honest prayer from you sound like this week?
4. *Apply:* David twice refused to take a shortcut to the throne. Where are you tempted to grab something before God's time?